[redacted]

Committee Secretary
Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters
Parliament House, Canberra ACT 2600
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November 14, 2025

Inquiry into the 2025 Federal Election Submission supported by Nicolette Boele MP

Dear Committee Secretariat,

Thank you for the opportunity to make a submission to the inquiry on the 2025 federal election.

In just one election period - between 2022 and 2025 - it became apparent that in Bradfield the behaviours of participants in these elections have changed for the worse. In turn, this has put a spotlight on system features that are being exploited for the benefit of a few, rather than for the benefit of electors more broadly. Without addressing these weaknesses, civic sentiment towards future elections – for voters and workers – will work against, rather in favour of strengthening our democracy.

This submission provides a summary and discussion from people intimately involved in our campaign for 2025. Of the 1,500 volunteers involved in polling day, 40% provided input to the post-election survey. The submission includes empirical evidence by way of anecdotes provided by [redacted] volunteers and others.

To prepare for this submission, we also convened a core group of volunteers to distil, analyse and summarise the survey results. This is *their* work supported by me.

Our submission focuses on the first four areas of the Committees' terms of reference. With the 2025 election behind us, we are focused on understanding the impacts of federal electoral reform on the other terms of reference and working with the AEC's FAD User Panels to understand the impact of that legislation; a process which is not yet complete.

There remain two areas of concern arising from the 2022 JSCEM recommendations that were not implemented in the revised laws passed by the Government with the support of the Opposition:

- the failure of the government to address lies in political advertising; and
- the lack of deliberation that has new electoral laws enter into force in 2026.

Both recommendations left unaddressed, arguably detract from, rather than strengthen Australia's democracy, and favour parties over people.

I look forward to working closely with you in this term to implement recommendations that help keep our federal elections fair and trusted and hence our treasured democracy strong.

[redacted]

[redacted]

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Executive Summary

Introduction

After the 2025 election, Bradfield became the most marginal federal seat in Australia, with a difference of only 26 votes. The size of this margin emphasises the importance of maximising informed and frictionless participation in our democracy. Too, the tightness of this outcome has highlighted and perhaps magnified potential vulnerabilities in our electoral system.

The amazing support of 1,500 volunteers has been humbling. However, the rigour of the campaign in Bradfield saw an uptick of inappropriate behaviour across the electorate.

Method

Following both the 2022 and 2025 elections, volunteers, donors and supporters were surveyed. Volunteers were asked: "What challenges did you face (if any) in fully participating in the campaign?" This question was not multiple choice and allowed a free form unprompted response.

Bradfield Experience

The second highest impediment identified by volunteers was "negative or hostile interactions" (see Figure 1). The reported experiences may negatively impact on citizen's intent to participate in future election campaigns and needs addressing by law makers and enforcers. This is key to helping repair and maintain a strong, fit for purpose democratic infrastructure.

Figure 1 What challenges did you face (if any) in full participation?

Another key experience centred around volunteer inability to engage with senior Bradfield voters, particularly those domiciled in residential aged care facilities (ACFs).

At the 2022 Federal Election, (pre-redistribution) Bradfield had the third highest proportion of postal voters in New South Wales, the highest concentration of permanent

aged care residents (near 50 facilities)[1]. In 2025, Bradfield was in the top 10 for NSW on postal votes, but the electorate size had increased by 20% post-redistribution.[2]

It is clear that the number of voters voting by post and the number living in ACFs is increasing. There are concerns about the pattern of reports of restrictions on the ability of residents to participate in our democracy, e.g., the ability to attend candidate forums or to be addressed by and question candidates, including restrictions on receiving how to votes, through to alarming reports of facility staff directing residents who to vote for.

For this reason, many of the recommendations are focussed on addressing the shortcomings presented from the interface between ACF management, the Australian Electoral Commission (AEC) and voters.

Summary of Recommendations

Safety and Security

To ensure the AEC meets its legislative obligations under the *Electoral Act 1918* (Cth) relating to the *Work Health and Safety Act 2011* (Cth), it is recommended that a framework be put in place to provide greater protection to voters.

1. Remove the 6 metre rule and replace with a requirement that voters, volunteers, and AEC staff not be intimidated, harassed or bullied ("obstructive behaviours").
2. Give the AEC responsibility and resources to be first port of call for any reports of obstructive behaviour within the vicinity of a polling place (where vicinity is redefined to a more practical radius e.g. 300 metres).
3. Define obstructive behaviour in law or regulations to include obstructive, aggressive and intimidating behaviour that interferes or is intended to interfere with the right of Australians to have political communication.
4. Provide the AEC with the authority to issue warning notices to any person in the vicinity of the polling place who is demonstrating obstructive behaviours.
5. Give the AEC legal authority to require offenders to leave the vicinity of the polling centre for improper behaviour. Also give AEC authority to issue formal warnings to repeat offenders, breach of which triggers referral to police.
6. Improve AEC training and public education so that:
   a. AEC can quickly escalate to local police if the offences continue or offenders become violent; and
   b. Voters and supporters be made aware of expected behaviour standards and that breaches can be reported.

[1] Australian Institute of Health and Welfare, *Australia's Welfare 2023* (2023); Australian Institute of Health and Welfare, *Australia's Welfare 2023* (2023). GEN data: Providers, services and places in aged care CURF - AIHW Gen

[2] See Figure 4 and TCP by Vote Type 2025

Figure 5, page 19 below

Addressing System Vulnerabilities - Postal Voting

7. Accept and implement recommendations from JSCEM 2022 Federal election review to ban any political party or candidate from involvement in the postal system. Without exception, only the AEC should be permitted to receive postal vote registrations.
8. Require political parties, elected members and candidates to align with privacy laws, namely the *Privacy Act 1988* (Cth) and the associated Australian Privacy Principles, and the aforementioned by incorporation into the *Electoral Act 1918* (Cth).

Addressing System Vulnerabilities - Residential Aged Care Facilities

9. Introduce a formal system of support, for use at both ACFs and Mobile Voting Stations, to ensure voters are provided with candidate information in advance, have the opportunity to talk with candidates' electioneering supporters if they choose and are provided with AEC advocates to ensure formality of voters' intention is captured.
10. Extend the positive gains relating to 'greater equity of access for people with disability' - cognitive and intellectual[3] - by adapting these tools and approaches for voters in the aged care setting.
11. Establish a mandatory register for voters with a Power of Attorney, relinquishing a right to vote and deregistration on electoral roll, i.e., 2022 JSCEM Recommendation 9 4.208 to be extended to ACFs).

Addressing System Vulnerabilities - Mobile Voting Stations

12. Include documentation and training for AEC mobile polling station officers about the existence, role and responsibilities of scrutineers at mobile voting station facilities. This should include notifying staff at facilities hosting mobile polling stations about where to direct candidate scrutineers.
13. Provide voters requiring assistance in completing their ballot paper with an independent, trained AEC advocate (not healthcare facility staff) to ensure formality of voter intention is captured without undue influence.

Authorisation Framework - Lies in Political Advertising

14. Adopt the recommendations of the JSCEM 2022 interim and final reports on
    a. addressing lies in political advertising
    b. the removal of the free to air TV advertisement "blackout" provisions.

[3] AEC Federal Election Report 2025.

Experience and recommendations

Terms of Reference 1 and 2 Safety and Security

Assessment and review of the purported increase in incidents of aggressive conduct deliberate obstruction, and intimidating behaviour towards voters, political participants, volunteers, and Australian Electoral Commission (AEC) officials. Potential reform of **safety and security arrangements**, including consideration of the powers, processes, and capacity of the AEC to manage and address increasingly threatening or disruptive behaviour.

Objectives of recommendations

- Ensure AEC legislative obligations under the *Electoral Act 1918* (Cth) relating to the *Work Health and Safety Act 2011* (Cth) to protect staff, temporary workers and voters are strengthened to provide participants with a safe and secure environment at pre-polling and polling booths, reinforced with the security of an effective reporting process.
- Provide a deterrent and mechanisms for accountability against behaviours intended to impede full participation in democracy and expressions of the implied right to freedom of political discourse ("obstructive behaviours"), whether at polling booths or electioneering activities in the wider electorate.
- Recognise that obstructive behaviours are such whether they occur at 5 metres from a polling place or 10 metres.

Bradfield's experience

[redacted] volunteers saw a pattern across the electorate of increased frequency and severity of intimidation, harassment, bullying and obstruction compared to 2022.

> **My campaign has extensive reports on the incidents that are reported below and anonymised. In some cases volunteers have agreed to let their names be known, in others not; similarly, in some cases volunteers have agreed to appear before JSCEM if asked, while others will not. Should the JSCEM wish to seek further information, please contact my Campaign Chair, [redacted] and he will make every effort to facilitate further communication.**

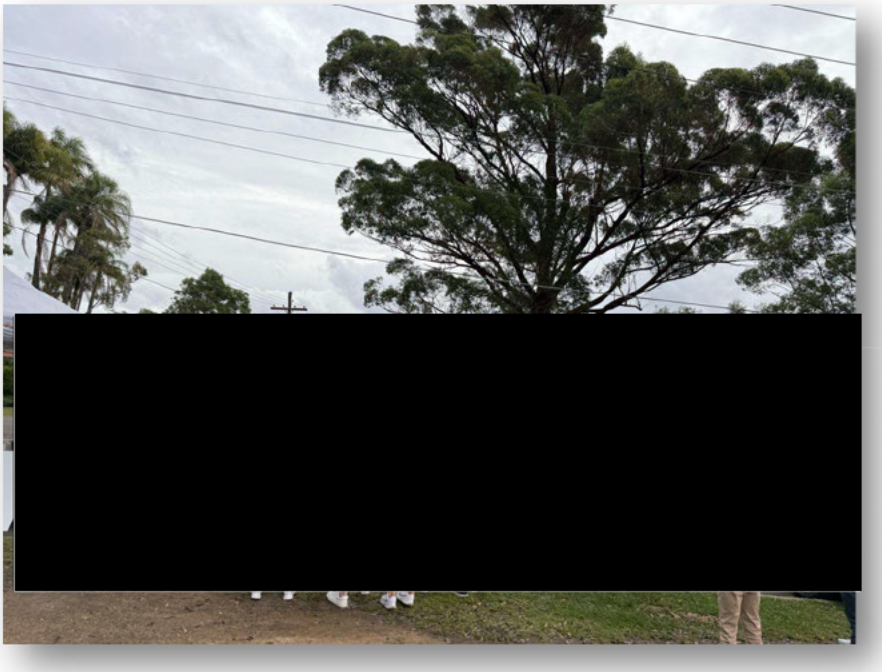
Thirty-eight incidents were reported to the [redacted] campaign; all except one involving people believed with some confidence to be [redacted] party members or supporters.

- Several incidents fell into more than one category, and were obstruction (8), aggression (14) and intimidation (31).
- Eight (8) incidents were problems at polling booths involving people believed to be members of the Plymouth Brethren church who were campaigning for the [redacted] candidate.
- It was the impression of many, that the widespread occurrence of similar events involving aggression and intimidation by [redacted] supporters, that there was an

organised pattern to disrupt other candidates' campaigns. Almost all of the incidents reported concerned actions directed at [redacted] supporters or voters.

- Disruption also included repeated theft of corflutes from private property which was experienced as intimidating behaviour by those property owners (see volunteer report on next page).

Figure 2 A gathering of [redacted] supporters - believed to be Brethren - at Killara Park pre-poll



Below is the text of a report from a volunteer:

> *To whom it may concern,*
>
> *In early April this year, I had eight [redacted] corflutes stolen from my property, so replaced them. I placed an Apple air tag in one of the new corflutes to see if I could track them if it happened again.*
>
> *During the lead up to the election many Utes started parking across the street from our place [redacted] on the weekends. The large group of mostly men were all wearing the [redacted] T-shirts, and it became very clear, as we started seeing the Brethren at polling booths, that they were from this group.*
>
> *They were there late on Sunday, April 27 when my corflutes disappeared again. I noticed the group was still there while walking my dog in the park at 5, and on my return at 6 pm there were still several Utes present.*

At 9pm that night I checked my apple tracker and noticed the tracker was showing the corflutes had again been removed and were crossing Sydney (images available), ending up at [redacted].

I then rang the police. The Event No. for this incident is [redacted]. The police assessed the repeated theft of eight corflutes as serious and responded by visiting the home at the above address. It is owned by [redacted], a member of the Brethren.

The police reported that they had spoken to the owner but didn't have permission to go in. They stated that apple trackers were reasonably accurate, implying to me that they thought the corflutes were there.

The morning after the corflutes were stolen there was a large bag of dirty nappies placed over the locked gate on my property (from where one corflute had been removed). I found this act both disgusting and frightening.

These actions seemed not only to be anti-democratic but also to be an act of aggressive intimidation, with no regard for the rights and property of others. I was angered by it, not only by what had happened to me but also, I'd heard of a single woman living alone, also in Killara, who had her corflutes stolen twice and then was too scared to replace them a third time.

On June 2 the corflutes were again on the move ending up at Clyde Transfer Centre, Clyde Waste Disposal centre (images available).

Obstruction

Incidents ranged from serious (stealing corflutes from private property) to minor (obstructing the path into a polling booth). Other examples include:

- Plymouth Brethren supporting the [redacted] inserting themselves between [redacted] volunteers and voters to interrupt conversations outside a polling booth.
- [redacted] supporting the [redacted] telling voters who had a [redacted] how-to-vote that they only needed to put the number 1 on the ballot paper. No need to number all the boxes, they said.

Aggression

All the incidents reported were serious and made the [redacted] volunteers or voters afraid to carry on, often for fear of escalation into physical harm. The venues included pre-polling centres, polling booths and in one case the Asquith counting centre. Examples include:

- [redacted] scrutineer threatened to reveal the home address of a [redacted] scrutineer and make an unwanted delivery [of something] to that address.
- Brethren supporting the [redacted] interfering in private conversation between [redacted] volunteer and a voter and bullying them. [redacted] volunteer intervened to get Brethren man away.
- Men of Asian appearance in [redacted] T-shirts grabbing women of Asian appearance as they approached a pre-polling centre and confiscating How-To-Vote (HTV) cards from

other candidates. The men then placed their candidate's HTV in the women's hands before escorting them to the voting centre.

- A [redacted] volunteer took the arm of a voter to lead her to a booth entrance, against her objections. Other [redacted] following voters all the way to the booth door.
- A known male member of the [redacted] party stood over two female [redacted] volunteers, such that they felt intimidated, bullied and belittled, including invading the personal space of one of them. This behaviour was vocally supported by about 10 other [redacted] volunteers (mostly male).
- A [redacted] volunteer appeared to threaten two female [redacted] volunteers at a booth and said "You may want to leave now as 30 Brethren are on their way".
- Two male Brethren supporting the [redacted] interfered with placement of [redacted] election material at booth and insulted [redacted] volunteer and the candidate (who was not present). Tried to bait and provoke the [redacted] volunteer.
- Aggressive behaviour and derogatory comments by large male voter to [redacted] at pre-poll. Used threatening behaviour and language including raised voice and advancing towards candidate. Got into loud argument with [redacted] volunteer trying to protect the candidate.
- A man believed to be a [redacted] party official used aggressive and intimidating language to an elderly female [redacted] volunteer at a pre-poll centre.
- Large number of male Brethren supporting the [redacted] impeded voters' paths at a booth and talked to voters against their wishes. Included two frail elderly voters with carers.
- [redacted] volunteer at a booth shouted at an 85-year-old [redacted] voter after she refused to take a flyer. Caused voter to be confused and upset.
- [redacted] volunteers and Brethren supporters being aggressive and overbearing to voters and other party volunteers.

Intimidation

All the incidents reported were serious and made the [redacted] volunteers or voters feel pressured not to vote for [redacted], not vote at all or stop supporting her candidature. The venues included pre-polling centres, polling booths, the Asquith counting centre and the streets of the electorate. Examples of intimidation that were not also listed under aggression (above) include:

- Mobile billboards (on trucks) authorised by the [redacted] with vile negative advertising about [redacted] cruised up and down outside at least one polling booth and a pre-poll centre to intimidate voters and volunteers. This included stopping outside the pre-poll centre.
- Persistent male [redacted] volunteer at pre-poll making unwanted assertions to a female [redacted] volunteer about sexual misconduct by an [redacted] member and about the [redacted] case. This included that "[redacted]". He continued these comments despite objections from the [redacted] volunteer until she walked away from him.

- A [redacted] staffer and volunteer took photos of the names and signatures of [redacted] scrutineers in the sign sheet at the Asquith counting centre. Despite being told by the AEC to delete the photos, they appeared in the media the next day.
- [redacted] supporters in the line to vote at a booth, wanting to engage with young female volunteers on the [redacted] team. This then led to some of male [redacted] volunteers stepping in to argue/protect the women. This was a typical escalation pattern.
- During a volunteer conversation with [redacted], a quite tall male [redacted] volunteer came inappropriately close to listen in on the conversations. It felt quite uncomfortable and limited freedom of discussion.
- In multiple typical interactions between [redacted] volunteers and the [redacted] team, it seemed that arguments would be initiated by typically male volunteers for the [redacted] with female volunteers on the [redacted] team.
- A Liberal campaign worker (not Brethren) used a squeaking toy duck to annoy other candidates' volunteers at a booth. He argued back when asked to stop this.

Security

As a result of these behaviours at pre-poll, the campaign decided to spend on hiring professional security guards to protect campaign material on the night before polling day at polling sites that were likely to be high traffic. This was not an expense the campaign incurred in 2022, but felt it was necessary in 2025.

Sites patrolled included:

- Artarmon Public School
- Beaumont Road Public School
- Castle Cove Public School
- Chatswood Public School
- Gordon East Public School
- Gordon West Public School
- Killara High School
- Killara Public School
- Lindfield East Public School
- Lindfield Public School
- Naremburn School
- Northbridge Public School
- Pymble Public School
- Roseville Public School
- Sacred Heart Pymble Primary School
- St Ives High School
- St Ives North Public School
- St Ives Park Public School
- St Lucy's School - for Students with Disabilities
- St Mark's Anglican Church Hall
- Turramurra High School
- Turramurra North Public School

- Turramurra Public School
- Wahroonga Public School
- Warrawee Public School
- West Pymble Public School
- Willoughby Park Centre
- Willoughby Public School

Incidents of attempted interference were reported at two sites. Each was prevented peacefully. The campaign has reason to believe that the presence of the security guards had a deterrent effect. Nevertheless, this is not an expense that any campaign should have to bear in Australia.

Recommendations

1. Remove the 6 metre rule and replace with requirement that voters, volunteers, and AEC staff not be intimidated, harassed or bullied ("obstructive behaviours").
2. Give the AEC responsibility and resources to be first port of call for any reports of obstructive behaviour within the vicinity of a polling place (where vicinity is redefined to a more practical radius e.g. 300 metres).
3. Define obstructive behaviour in law or regulations to include obstructive, aggressive and intimidating behaviour that interferes or is intended to interfere with the right of Australians to have political communication.
4. Provide the AEC with the authority to issue warning notices to any person in the vicinity of the polling place who is demonstrating obstructive behaviours.
5. Give the AEC legal authority to require offenders to leave the vicinity of the polling centre for improper behaviour. Also give AEC authority to issue formal warnings to repeat offenders, breach of which triggers referral to police.
6. Improve AEC training and public education so that:
   a. AEC to be trained to quickly escalate to local police if the offences continue or offenders become violent and
   b. Voters and supporters be made aware of expected behaviour standards and that breaches can be reported.

Terms of Reference 3 - Voter Access

The suitability and potential reform of measures to ensure universal voter access, including polling booth availability and location, early voting, remote polling, and postal voting arrangements.

Objectives of recommendations

- To ensure voters have universal access to voting and are provided with options of balanced access to candidate information, to inform decisions.
- Ensure voters are not misled or confused by postal vote communications, and vulnerable voters and people with English as a Second Language are not taken disadvantaged.

- Ensure there is no opportunity for third party interference to the postal voting process, including eliminate the opportunity for third party interference in the completion of ballot papers in Residential Aged Care Facilities (ACF)[4] and Retirement Living.
- Protect voters from unknowingly being exposed to data harvesting by political candidates and their parties, without express permission.
- Support electoral roll integrity to include deregistration of voters with recognised demise in faculties, rendering them unable to vote.
- Ensure the mobile voting system provides appropriate supports for voters to make informed decisions and formal votes.

Bradfield's experience

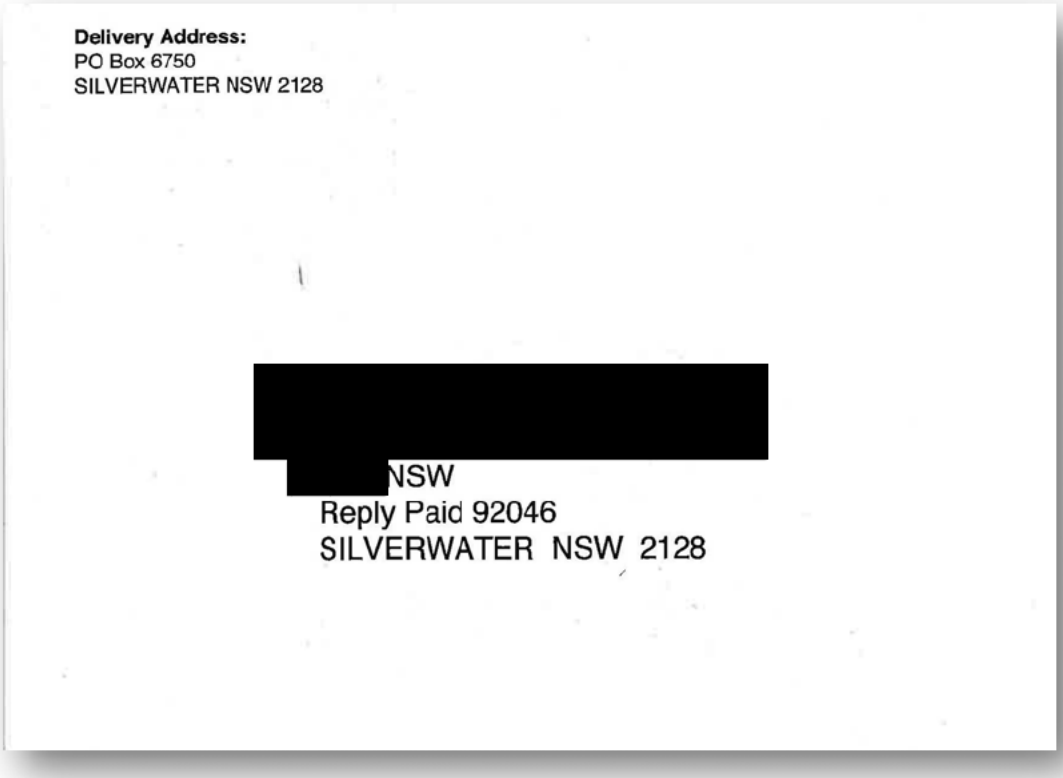
Postal Voting

Parties, other than the AEC, have appeared to abuse the postal voting system by misleading voters with the inclusion of registration material in AEC colours, included with candidate material (some voters suggesting that it was easily perceived as how you need to vote).

Voters who volunteers spoke to, were unaware that they were returning completed forms to the [redacted] Party for example. Note that the example in Figure 3: [redacted] Party Self Addressed Envelope for return of postal vote applications cites the return address as "[redacted]" not "[redacted]".

[4] Unless mentioned otherwise, any reference to an ACF herein is a reference to Residential Aged Care Facility

Figure 3: [redacted] Party Self Addressed Envelope for return of postal vote applications



Residential Aged Care facilities

Observations ranged from ACFs not providing any assistance to voters to participate in elections through to extremes where the resident's vote was taken out of their hands, or they were provided with (at best) incorrect information or (at worst) deliberate misinformation in the course of casting their vote.

During 2024, the campaign commissioned quantitative and qualitative research into potential barriers or impediments to voting in ACFs. It concluded that the postal voting behaviour in favour of the [redacted] candidate in Bradfield was due to both generational behaviour and institutional barriers. Of concern, are the institutional and structural barriers that impede equal access to civic participation.

> Turramurra House is an ACF in Bradfield with around 100 residents. The AEC Mobile Voting unit was scheduled to visit on 30 April 2025 (schedules of visits were provided by the AEC Divisional Returning Officer to the campaign). However, the unit did not arrive and despite the suggestion it would be there on the coming days, it never did turn up. Unless residents had access to supportive transport or had also registered for a postal vote, they were unable to vote in the election.[5]

[5] Correspondence 27 May 25, on file

Voter access to candidate information

- At the Landings mobile polling station on 22 April 2025, a [redacted] scrutineer provided HTV cards to the AEC officer for distribution to voters if they requested.[6] The [redacted] scrutineer observed several people ask for leaflets but none were given a [redacted] HTV. The scrutineer noted that 166 votes had been cast at The Landings mobile voting station and it's therefore significant that none had access to [redacted] HTV cards.
- A focus group participant reported that when trying to assist a friend who lived at an ACF outside of Bradfield to vote postally, the ACF said "[w]e won't have anything to do with voting" and the interviewee believed that no one inside the facility was helped to vote.[7]
- The [redacted] team was not permitted to provide HTV cards in an ACF because the [redacted] candidate's HTV cards had not been made available.[8]
- Numerous ACFs in Bradfield, were closed shops to candidates other than [redacted]

Undue influence on confused voters

- The [redacted] team had been informed of several cases of elderly relatives in ACFs being shown a picture of a candidate and asked if they'd like to vote for 'this lady' and having ballots filled in for them – while quite unaware that they were voting.[9]
- At the mobile polling station at Estia Health in Willoughby a [redacted] scrutineer observed a healthcare facility worker being allowed to sit with each resident as they voted. On multiple occasions this person was observed making inappropriate comments such as *'your daughter has told me how she wants you to vote so put 1 in this box here'*, or reading the whole ballot paper out and then saying *'now you want to vote* [redacted] *don't you, so put 1 here'*. Several times this person was told by AEC staff to stop doing this, but the [redacted] scrutineer reported that she continued to make statements guiding residents as they filled in their ballot.[10]
- BUPA Willoughby - candidate presented to 16-18 voting residents. The majority of this group appeared 'medicated', raising questions about their ability to make an informed voting decision and whether they had POAs in place.[11]
- At the mobile polling station at BUPA Aged Care facility in St Ives on 23 April 25 a [redacted] scrutineer observed that AEC and BUPA staff had to assist the majority of voters as they were confused about the voting process, often sitting in front of a ballot paper for up to 10 minutes without writing on the ballot paper.

Mobile Voting Stations

The campaign had allocated scrutineers to attend all scheduled mobile services in Bradfield, at 20 sites, from 22 April - 1 May 2025.[12] However, the campaign team discontinued scrutineering after attending six mobile polling units in the first two days, upon feedback from [redacted] scrutineers.

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[6] per AEC instructions, Correspondence 16 April 25, on file
[7] personal communication, 27 September 24.
[8] Correspondence 22 April 25, on file
[9] [redacted] - submission
[10] Campaign - Aged Care Facilities - Mobile Voting report
[11] Internal diary note 25 March 2025
[12] Based on the schedule provided by the AEC DRO

- **Special Hospital Team 1:** AEC officer in charge at The Landings[13] (22 April 25) was not expecting see candidates' scrutineers, and commented she had 'never seen a scrutineer at a mobile polling booth after working at state and federal elections for many years'. She declined the scrutineer's offer to show her the AEC letter (16/4/25) to the [redacted] campaign outlining the role of scrutineers at mobile units. She did not have any scrutineer identification badges to supply the [redacted] scrutineer (as outlined in the AEC letter). The AEC officer informed the scrutineer that the mobile unit at Royal North Shore hospital the next day would be in a 'locked ward' where scrutineers would 'probably not be allowed in'.
- **Special Hospital Team 2:** Polling at KOWPA was scheduled to start at 10:15 am, but the [redacted] scrutineer arrived at 9:50 am to find that voting that the AEC officer had arrived at 9am and voting had already started. The facility's receptionist at KOWPA was not expecting scrutineers, made two phone calls to colleagues seeking advice, and was given instructions not to admit our scrutineer to the facility. The scrutineer left without entering.
- The AEC team at BUPA St Ives (23 April 25) were surprised to see a [redacted] scrutineer, but accepted the AEC letter regarding candidate scrutineers at mobile voting units, gave her a lanyard, invited her to witness the breaking of the seals on the ballot boxes, and provided with a seat. The scrutineer was able to place HTV cards on a table at the front door.
- **Special Hospital Team 3:** AEC officer at St Paul's Catholic Healthcare residence (22 April 25) had not been expecting scrutineers and rang their supervisor and 'someone in Canberra' to check about our attendance. The officer initially gave our scrutineer an AEC vest and told them to stand 6m down a corridor to hand out how to vote leaflets. The scrutineer told them of the specific instruction not to hand out how to vote cards directly to voters. The scrutineer provided a plain folder containing [redacted] how to vote cards to sit on the officials table.
- At the mobile polling station at Estia Health in Willoughby the [redacted] scrutineer observed that most voters needed some help with the voting process because of poor eyesight or diminished comprehension. A healthcare facility worker was allowed to sit with each resident as they voted (see above: Undue influence on confused voters).

Recommendations

Postal Voting

7. Accept and implement recommendations from JSCEM 2022 Federal election review, to ban any political party or candidate from involvement in the postal system. Without exception, only the AEC should be permitted to receive postal vote registrations.
8. Require political parties, elected members and candidates to align with privacy laws, namely *Privacy Act 1988* (Cth) and the associated Australian Privacy Principles by incorporation into the *Electoral Act 1918* (Cth).

[13] A North Turramurra Seniors' Living facility

Residential Aged Care Facilities

9. Introduce a formal system of support, for use at both ACFs and Mobile Voting Stations, to ensure voters are provided with candidate information in advance, have opportunity to talk with candidates' electioneering supporters if they choose and are provided with AEC advocates to ensure formality of voters' intention is captured.
10. Extend the positive gains relating to 'greater equity of access for people with disability' - cognitive and intellectual [14] by adapting these tools and approaches for voters in the aged care setting.
11. Establish a mandatory register for voters with a Power of Attorney, relinquishing a right to vote and deregistration on electoral roll (2022 JSCEM Recommendation 9 4.208 to be extended to ACFs).

Mobile Voting Stations

12. Include documentation and training for AEC mobile polling station officers about the existence, role and responsibilities of scrutineers at mobile polling station facilities. This should include notifying staff at facilities hosting mobile polling stations about where to direct candidate scrutineers.
13. Provide voters requiring assistance in completing their ballot paper with an independent, trained AEC advocate (not healthcare facility staff) to ensure formality of voter intention is captured without undue influence.

Terms of Reference 4 - Authorisation Framework

The suitability of the current authorisation framework and requirements, having regard to the evolution of communication methods and technology.

Objectives of recommendations

- Recognise that timing restrictions placed on free to air TV advertising (e.g., blackout periods) are irrelevant in age of digital media
- Provide voters with the confidence that political communications are clearly authorised by genuine political participants, truthful, and in turn support confidence and trust in candidates, elected members and governments.
- Provide voters with easy access to information regarding political communication that has been shown to be untruthful.
- Ensure campaign material does not contain mis and disinformation and there is a process for reporting, accountability and consequences to material found to be unapproved and/or intentionally misleading – in real time.

Recommendations

Lies in Political Advertising

[14] AEC Federal Election Report 2025

14. Adopt the recommendations of the JSCEM 2022 interim and final reports on addressing lies in political advertising and the removal of the “blackout” provision should be adopted. More detail shall be provided after the review of the JSCEM 2025 interim report.

Appendices

TCP by Vote Type 2022

Figure 4: 2022 NSW Divisions by postal vote proportion

Division	Ord%TTL	Abs%TTL	Prov%TTL	PrePoll%TTL	Post%TTL
Parramatta	77.6%	3.9%	0.1%	3.2%	15.1%
Blaxland	79.0%	4.0%	0.1%	2.8%	14.0%
Bennelong	80.1%	2.9%	0.1%	3.0%	13.9%
Reid	79.6%	3.4%	0.1%	3.3%	13.4%
Mitchell	80.9%	3.0%	0.1%	2.6%	13.3%
Berowra	81.3%	2.7%	0.1%	2.8%	13.0%
Werriwa	81.6%	3.1%	0.1%	2.5%	12.8%
[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]
Watson	79.9%	4.6%	0.1%	2.9%	12.5%
Banks	82.6%	3.2%	0.1%	2.4%	11.7%
Wentworth	80.4%	3.0%	0.2%	4.9%	11.6%
Robertson	82.9%	2.8%	0.1%	2.8%	11.4%
Shortland	83.4%	3.1%	0.1%	2.0%	11.4%
Hume	83.2%	3.1%	0.1%	2.6%	11.1%
Dobell	83.5%	3.0%	0.1%	2.5%	10.9%
Greenway	83.5%	3.5%	0.1%	2.2%	10.8%
McMahon	82.4%	4.3%	0.1%	2.6%	10.7%
Lindsay	84.0%	3.1%	0.1%	2.3%	10.6%
Gilmore	84.1%	1.8%	0.1%	3.6%	10.5%
Mackellar	84.5%	2.6%	0.1%	2.4%	10.4%
Farrer	84.8%	0.9%	0.1%	4.0%	10.3%
Eden-Monaro	84.8%	1.3%	0.1%	3.6%	10.3%
Chifley	83.3%	3.9%	0.1%	2.5%	10.2%
Warringah	82.8%	3.3%	0.1%	3.6%	10.2%
Barton	82.9%	4.0%	0.1%	2.8%	10.2%
Sydney	78.9%	5.3%	0.2%	5.5%	10.1%
Macarthur	84.1%	3.5%	0.1%	2.3%	10.0%
Cook	85.0%	2.6%	0.1%	2.2%	10.0%
Macquarie	84.9%	2.4%	0.1%	2.7%	9.9%
Paterson	85.5%	2.5%	0.1%	2.1%	9.8%
Kingsford Smith	83.3%	3.1%	0.1%	3.7%	9.7%
Whitlam	85.7%	2.3%	0.1%	2.5%	9.4%
Newcastle	84.9%	3.1%	0.1%	2.6%	9.3%
Hunter	85.9%	2.7%	0.1%	2.5%	8.8%
Fowler	85.5%	3.4%	0.1%	2.3%	8.8%
Lyne	86.1%	2.6%	0.1%	2.6%	8.6%
Cunningham	86.3%	2.3%	0.1%	2.8%	8.5%
Richmond	86.2%	1.6%	0.1%	3.7%	8.5%
Grayndler	83.8%	3.9%	0.2%	3.7%	8.4%

Division	Ord%TTL	Abs%TTL	Prov%TTL	PrePoll%TTL	Post%TTL
Hughes	85.6%	3.5%	0.1%	2.4%	8.4%
Page	86.2%	2.0%	0.1%	3.3%	8.4%
Cowper	86.9%	2.0%	0.1%	2.9%	8.1%
Parkes	86.5%	2.3%	0.0%	3.2%	7.9%
Riverina	86.6%	1.8%	0.1%	3.7%	7.9%
New England	88.3%	1.8%	0.1%	2.8%	7.0%
Calare	89.0%	1.9%	0.1%	2.7%	6.4%

Source:[15]

TCP by Vote Type 2025

Figure 5: 2025 NSW Divisions by postal vote proportion

Division	Ord%TTL	Abs%TTL	Prov%TTL	PrePoll%TTL	Post%TTL
Parramatta	77.6%	3.9%	0.1%	3.2%	15.1%
Blaxland	79.0%	4.0%	0.1%	2.8%	14.0%
Bennelong	80.1%	2.9%	0.1%	3.0%	13.9%
Reid	79.6%	3.4%	0.1%	3.3%	13.4%
Mitchell	80.9%	3.0%	0.1%	2.6%	13.3%
Berowra	81.3%	2.7%	0.1%	2.8%	13.0%
Werriwa	81.6%	3.1%	0.1%	2.5%	12.8%
[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]	[redacted]
Watson	79.9%	4.6%	0.1%	2.9%	12.5%
Banks	82.6%	3.2%	0.1%	2.4%	11.7%
Wentworth	80.4%	3.0%	0.2%	4.9%	11.6%
Robertson	82.9%	2.8%	0.1%	2.8%	11.4%
Shortland	83.4%	3.1%	0.1%	2.0%	11.4%
Hume	83.2%	3.1%	0.1%	2.6%	11.1%
Dobell	83.5%	3.0%	0.1%	2.5%	10.9%
Greenway	83.5%	3.5%	0.1%	2.2%	10.8%
McMahon	82.4%	4.3%	0.1%	2.6%	10.7%
Lindsay	84.0%	3.1%	0.1%	2.3%	10.6%
Gilmore	84.1%	1.8%	0.1%	3.6%	10.5%
Mackellar	84.5%	2.6%	0.1%	2.4%	10.4%
Farrer	84.8%	0.9%	0.1%	4.0%	10.3%
Eden-Monaro	84.8%	1.3%	0.1%	3.6%	10.3%
Chifley	83.3%	3.9%	0.1%	2.5%	10.2%
Warringah	82.8%	3.3%	0.1%	3.6%	10.2%
Barton	82.9%	4.0%	0.1%	2.8%	10.2%
Sydney	78.9%	5.3%	0.2%	5.5%	10.1%
Macarthur	84.1%	3.5%	0.1%	2.3%	10.0%
Cook	85.0%	2.6%	0.1%	2.2%	10.0%
Macquarie	84.9%	2.4%	0.1%	2.7%	9.9%
Paterson	85.5%	2.5%	0.1%	2.1%	9.8%

[15] "Two candidate preferred by candidate by vote type", AEC Tally room 2022 election downloads

Division	Ord%TTL	Abs%TTL	Prov%TTL	PrePoll%TTL	Post%TTL
Kingsford Smith	83.3%	3.1%	0.1%	3.7%	9.7%
Whitlam	85.7%	2.3%	0.1%	2.5%	9.4%
Newcastle	84.9%	3.1%	0.1%	2.6%	9.3%
Hunter	85.9%	2.7%	0.1%	2.5%	8.8%
Fowler	85.5%	3.4%	0.1%	2.3%	8.8%
Lyne	86.1%	2.6%	0.1%	2.6%	8.6%
Cunningham	86.3%	2.3%	0.1%	2.8%	8.5%
Richmond	86.2%	1.6%	0.1%	3.7%	8.5%
Grayndler	83.8%	3.9%	0.2%	3.7%	8.4%
Hughes	85.6%	3.5%	0.1%	2.4%	8.4%
Page	86.2%	2.0%	0.1%	3.3%	8.4%
Cowper	86.9%	2.0%	0.1%	2.9%	8.1%
Parkes	86.5%	2.3%	0.0%	3.2%	7.9%
Riverina	86.6%	1.8%	0.1%	3.7%	7.9%
New England	88.3%	1.8%	0.1%	2.8%	7.0%
Calare	89.0%	1.9%	0.1%	2.7%	6.4%

Source: [16]

Services and place in Residential Aged Care at 30 June 2024

At least 50 of NSW's 103 facilities are in Bradfield.

[17]

Number of residential care facilities in NSW in 2024: 823

Number of short-term restorative care facilities in NSW in 2024: 39

NSW Total of the two categories: 862

Number of residential care facilities in NSW in Northern Sydney 2024: 103

Number of short-term restorative care facilities in Northern Sydney in 2024: 5

Total: 108

Source: [18]GEN data: Providers, services and places in aged care CURF

[16] "Two candidate preferred by candidate by vote type", AEC Tally room 2025 election downloads
[17] GEN data: Providers, services and places in aged care CURF - AIHW Gen
[18] GEN data: Providers, services and places in aged care CURF - AIHW Gen